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Gun shop visit clouds deportation appeal

Mahdawi, held in Vt., disputes he sought to procure arms, made antisemitic remark

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WINDSOR, Vt. — Ten years after a young Palestinian man walked into a rural gun shop on the banks of the Connecticut River, his encounter with the gunsmith inside has become a contested episode in an immigration fight playing out on the national stage.

The Palestinian man, Mohsen Mahdawi, is fighting the Trump administration's attempts to deport him after he was arrested in April in

Vermont. The Columbia University student and green-card holder alleged he was targeted due to his pro-Palestinian advocacy, alongside other foreign-born protesters. A federal judge in Vermont agreed, finding the government had likely violated Mahdawi's First Amendment rights, and released him on bail.

On Tuesday, the administration's appeal of that decision is scheduled for argument before a US Appeals Court panel in New York City.

The same panel will also hear an

appeal in the case of Rümeysa Öztürk, the Tufts graduate student who was arrested by federal authorities in March, because she coauthored an opinion in the student newspaper that was critical of Israel, according to her legal team. A judge ordered Öztürk's release on May 9.

Mahdawi's and Öztürk's appeals largely center on whether the Vermont judges who heard their respective cases had jurisdiction to intervene in immigration cases. But in its court filings, the government also points to Mahdawi's 2015 visit to the Vermont gun shop to argue he is a violent antisemitic who poses a risk to the public.

Citing a decade-old police report, federal prosecutors allege Mahdawi built guns used to kill Jews while he was living in the West Bank. No charges were ever brought, and the judge in Vermont dismissed the accusations as unfounded when he released Mahdawi on bail.

"That decision was bad enough on its own," federal prosecutors wrote. "It is particularly misguided in this case, which involves an alien with a criminal background and history of boasting that he 'kill[ed] Jews' while in Palestine and that he would like to continue killing Jews going forward (in the specific con-

GUN SHOP, Page A7

Deal still elusive as shutdown draws near

Health care subsidies, Medicaid cuts divide Republicans, Democrats

By Riley Beggin, Hannah Natanson, and Marianna Sotomayor
WASHINGTON POST

A government shutdown early Wednesday looked increasingly likely after a White House meeting with congressional leaders left Democrats and Republicans no closer to agreeing on how to fund continued operations.

"I think we're headed into a shutdown because the Democrats won't do the right thing," Vice President JD Vance said after the meeting.

Democratic leaders said they raised their concerns about health care with President Trump, who Senate minority leader Charles E. Schumer said "seemed to understand for the first time the magnitude of this crisis." Yet they indicated the two sides remained far apart on an agreement.

Republican leaders signaled that they are unwilling to consider Democrats' demands, and they urged Senate Democrats to agree to a GOP plan the House has already passed that would extend current funding until Nov. 21.

If Congress fails to approve a funding extension by the end of Tuesday, spending laws will expire and the US government will become a barebones operation, continuing only functions neces-

SHUTDOWN, Page A6



ANDREW CABALLERO-REYNOLDS/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

President Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu discussed the 20-point peace plan at the White House on Monday.

US, Israel lay path to peace in Gaza

Trump's plan faces hurdles, including acceptance by Hamas, but hopes rise

By Aaron Boxerman, Liam Stack, and Adam Rasgon
NEW YORK TIMES

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel said Monday that he supported a 20-point plan released by President Trump to end the Israeli military campaign in the Gaza Strip, free the remaining hostages, and rebuild the devastated territory.

But Trump and Netanyahu, speaking at the White House, both said they would support Israel continuing the war if Hamas rejected the deal. Hamas had no immediate comment on the proposal. And it appeared improbable at best that Hamas would agree to a demand in the plan that it disarm without a full Israeli withdrawal from the territory.

Netanyahu said if Hamas did not embrace the proposal, "then Israel will finish

the job by itself." He added: "This can be done the easy way or it can be done the hard way, but it will be done."

Trump said if Hamas did not agree to the proposal, he would support Israel as it continued its military assault, which has killed tens of thousands of Palestinians. "Israel would have my full backing to finish the job of destroying the threat of Hamas," Trump said.

Before Trump and Netanyahu spoke, Taher al-Nounou, a senior Hamas official, said in a televised interview Monday that the group had not been involved in developing the plan.

"When it comes to this plan, no one contacted us, nor were we part of the negotiations around it," he said.

Still, Trump expressed hope that the proposal would finally bring an end to the

nearly two-year war and create a framework to govern postwar Gaza. It calls for Gaza to be governed by a temporary, "technocratic, apolitical Palestinian committee," overseen by an international "Board of Peace," which would be led by Trump and include other world leaders, including Tony Blair, a former British prime minister. Hamas would have no role in governing Gaza under the plan, which the White House released Monday just before Trump and Netanyahu spoke to reporters.

"We're, at a minimum, very, very close," Trump said. "And I think we're beyond very close."

Netanyahu thanked him for offering the proposal.

"I support your plan to end the war in Gaza, which achieves our war aims," he

GAZA, Page A5

Oh, say, can you see? The story of The Streak.

Sox playoff run really got going on July 4, with first of ten straight victories

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

When the Red Sox woke up in Washington on July 4, they were stuck in the mucky middle of the American League, losers more often than they were winners, insistent in a belief that, through the halfway point of the season, had not aligned with reality.

It was the day everything changed.

Now, they are where they always thought they would be: in the postseason for the first time in four years, beginning Tuesday when they visit the Yankees in New York. First pitch is at 6:08 p.m.

A survey of players and staff who have been around for the whole wild ride opened with one question: When did the Red Sox turn around their season?

RED SOX, Page C4



In the news



A reflective Jayson Tatum, out indefinitely as he recovers from an Achilles' heel tear, joined his teammates on the Celtics media day. C1.

The Department of Health and Human Services formally recommended barring Harvard University from receiving federal funding. D1.

Moldova's voters resisted Russian interference and backed a pro-European party in parliamentary elections. A3.

Set in our rays

Tuesday: Tons of sun. High 73-78, low 50-55.

Wednesday: Sun and wind. High 61-66, low 47-52.

Sunrise: 6:40. Sunset: 6:27.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Students still struggle to regain learning

MCAS results below prepandemic levels as scores stir questions

By Christopher Huffaker, John Hilliard, and Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

ARLINGTON — More than five years after the COVID-19 pandemic shut down schools for months, Massachusetts students continue to lag far below prepandemic levels on state tests, according to MCAS scores released Monday.

The results show very little progress from 2024 to 2025, with notable declines among high school students. The scores raise questions about whether the state is doing enough to catch students up to their prepandemic peers and about what the long-term effect of declining performance could be on the students' readiness for college and the job market and the state's economy.



DAVID L. RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF

Education Commissioner Pedro Martinez joined students at Arlington's Ottoson Middle School on Monday. Arlington schools have shown MCAS improvements.

Leaders continue to emphasize Massachusetts' top ranking on tests known as the "Nation's Report Card," but the state's edge appears to be slipping.

"The distinction we've earned over the last several decades of leading the nation is a characteristic that's becoming unraveled," said Edward Lambert, executive director of the Massachusetts Business Alliance for Education. "Other states are recovering from the pandemic, and we don't seem to be at

MCAS, Page A10